

HOLLOW GROWTH

Finding the Best Countries for a \$100M Aid Fund

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Introduction & Background

For many years, people have used income per person to measure how “developed” a country is.

But having more money does not always mean people live longer or healthier lives.

Too Many People, Not Enough to Go Around

The country earns more money overall, but the population also grows fast — so each person doesn't actually get much richer.

Money Goes Up, Health Does Not

People earn more money, but they don't end up living longer or healthier lives.

We call this “hollow growth”: the economy looks good on paper, but people's lives are not actually getting better underneath.

Problem Statement & Project Goals

A group in charge of \$100M wants to give this money to countries that need it most — but normal income numbers can hide the real problem.

Main question: which countries got richer, but people's health did not get better?

Project Goals

- Clean and combine data on population, income, and life expectancy (1960-2020)
- Compare how much each country's income grew vs. how much people's health improved
- Find the “hollow growth” countries so we know where the \$100M should go

\$100M

Money waiting to go to the right countries

60 years of data

3 things measured

184 countries

Data & Methodology

Population

How many people lived in each country, 1960-2020

Income per Person

Average yearly income per person, adjusted so it's fair to compare across years

Life Expectancy

The average number of years a person is expected to live

For each country, we looked at:

- How fast income grew each year, from 1960 to 2020 (this way, rich and poor countries can be compared fairly)
- How many extra years of life people gained during that same time

We marked a country as “hollow growth” if its income grew faster than most countries, but people's life expectancy grew slower than most.

What's Ahead

01 How we found the hollow growth countries

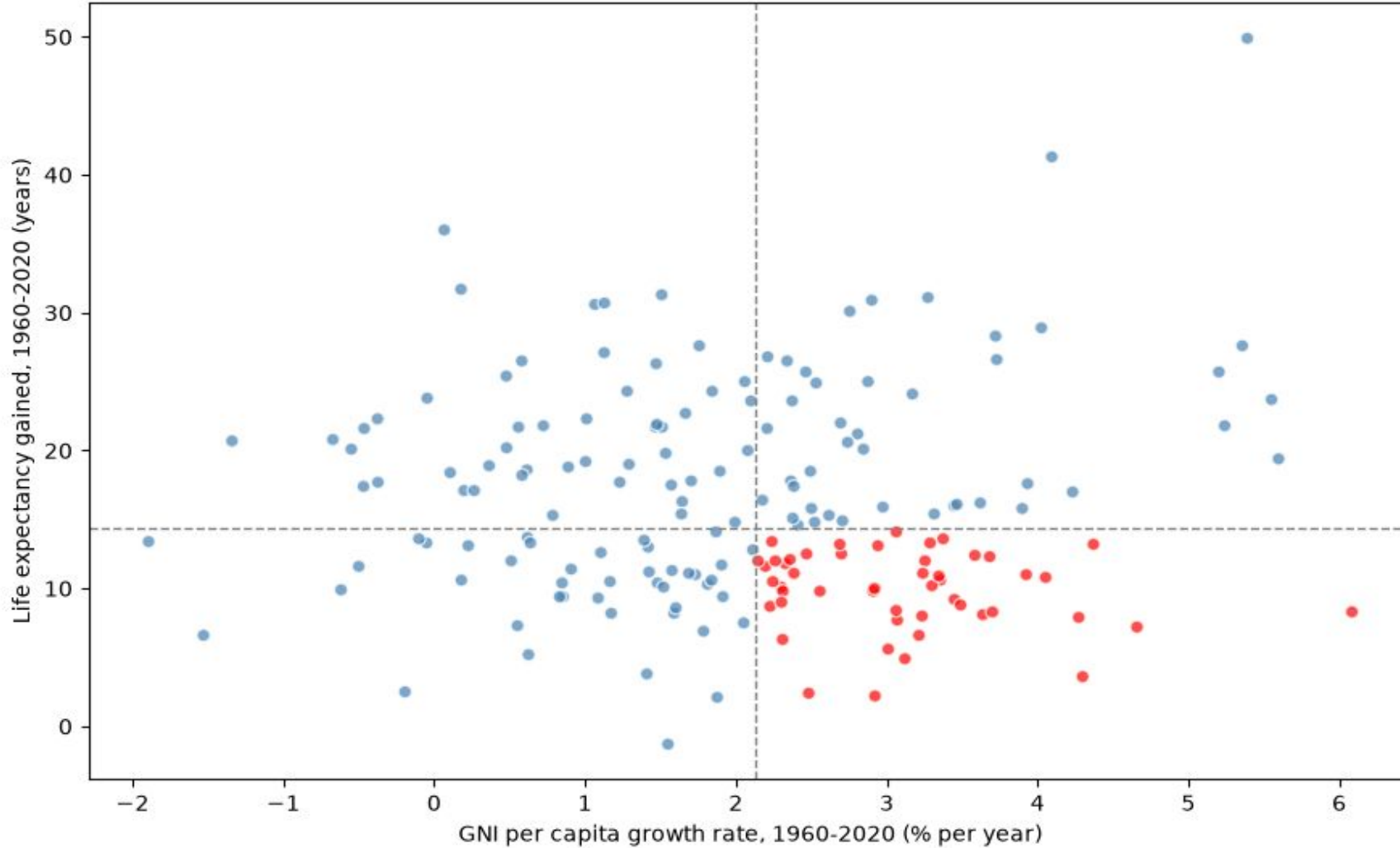
02 The countries that stood out the most

03 Our recommendation for the \$100M

Income Growth vs. Life Expectancy Gains

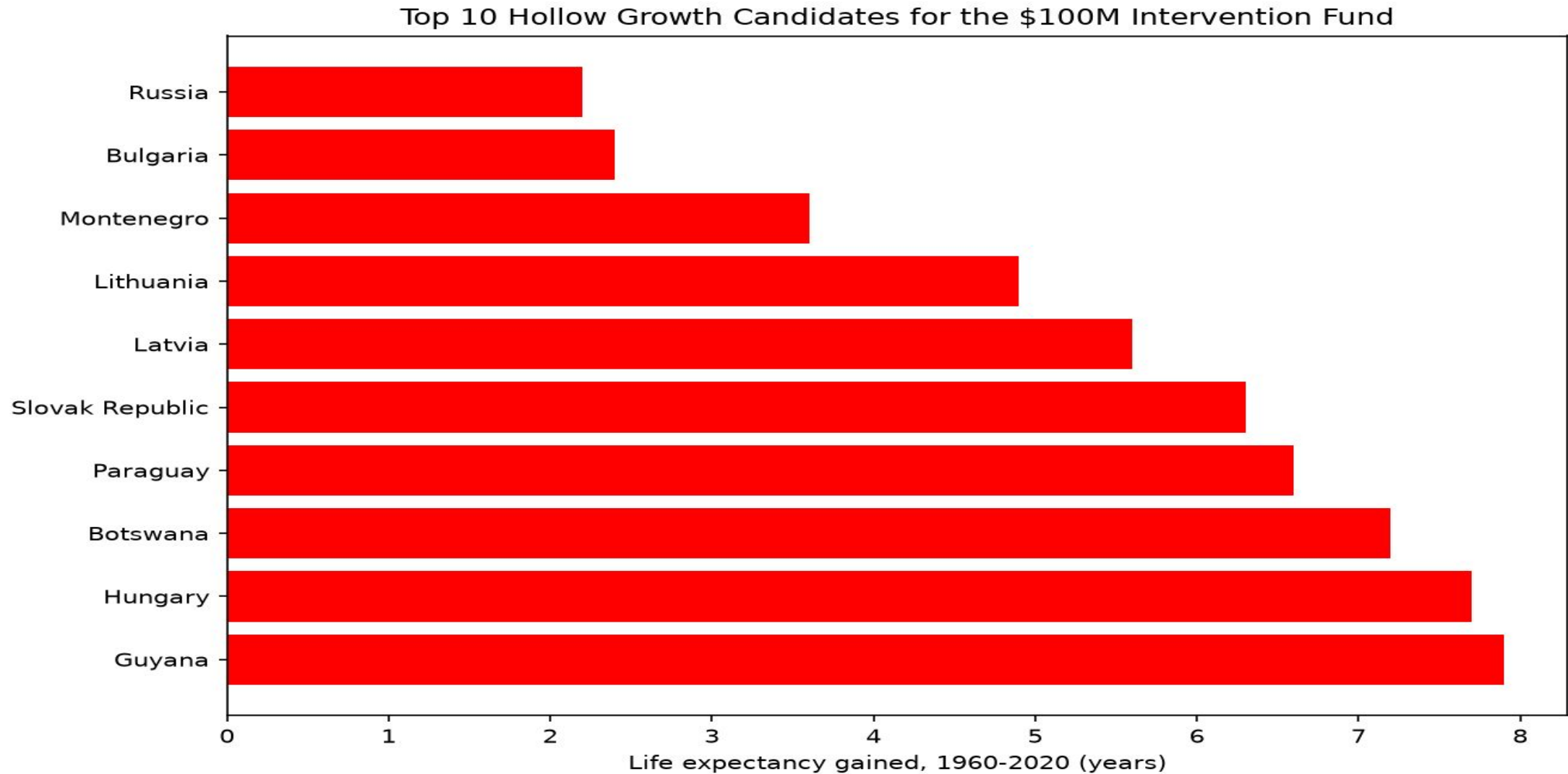
Each dot is one country. Red dots are the “hollow growth” countries.

Income Growth vs. Life Expectancy Gains, by Country



Top 10 Hollow Growth Countries

These countries got richer fast, but people's health barely improved.



The Big Takeaway

49

out of 184 countries show this problem: their income grew a lot, but people's health did not improve much.

Getting richer does not always mean people live longer or healthier lives.

Recommendations & Next Steps

Countries to Help First

- **Guyana, Hungary, Botswana**
- Paraguay, Slovak Republic, Latvia
- Lithuania, Montenegro, Bulgaria, Russia

Next Steps

- Look closer at each country before giving out the money
- This is just a first check, not the final decision
- Redo this check every few years with new data